BELIEF
COUNSELING

Cognitive Errors Checklist

Please check any thinking patterns you recognize in yourself.

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Filtering the Evidence

☐ **Selective attention** — noticing only what fits my belief
"Nobody said hello to me today."

☐ **Confirmatory bias** — looking for proof I'm right, ignoring the rest
"See? This just proves it again."

☐ **Mental filter** — dwelling on the one negative
"One bad comment ruined the whole day."

☐ **Disqualifying the positive** — deciding good things don't count
"They were only being nice."

An example from my own thinking:

Extreme Thinking

☐ **All-or-nothing thinking** — no middle ground
"If it isn't perfect, it's a failure."

☐ **Overgeneralization** — one event becomes a rule
"This always happens to me."

☐ **Catastrophizing** — expecting the worst possible outcome
"If I lose this job, my life is over."

☐ **Minimization** — shrinking my strengths or successes
"Anyone could have done that."

An example from my own thinking:

Guessing and Predicting

☐ **Mind reading** — assuming I know what others think
"She thinks I'm stupid."

☐ **Fortune telling** — predicting a bad outcome
"It won't work out, so why try?"

☐ **Jumping to conclusions** — deciding without the facts
"He didn't text back — he's angry."

☐ **Emotional reasoning** — I feel it, so it must be true
"I feel worthless, so I am worthless."

An example from my own thinking:

Labels and Blame

☐ **Global labeling** — one mistake becomes who I am
"I'm a loser."

☐ **Personalization** — taking blame for things outside my control
"It's my fault they divorced."

☐ **Blaming others** — others are responsible for how I feel
"You made me this angry."

☐ **Hindsight bias** — I should have seen it coming
"I should have known better."

An example from my own thinking:

Rules and Standards

☐ **Should statements** — rigid musts and oughts
"I should never feel anxious."

☐ **Perfectionism** — standards no one could meet
"Anything less than my best is unacceptable."

☐ **Comparisons** — measuring myself against others
"Everyone else has it together."

☐ **Unrealistic expectations** — expecting too much of myself or others
"A good Christian wouldn't struggle like this."

An example from my own thinking:

Control and Coping

☐ **Helplessness** — outside forces control everything
"Nothing I do makes any difference."

☐ **Over-responsibility** — I must control every outcome
"If anything goes wrong, it's on me."

☐ **Underestimating myself** — doubting I can cope
"I could never handle that."

☐ **Avoidance** — pushing away painful thoughts
"If I don't think about it, it isn't real."

An example from my own thinking:

Putting It Together

Which errors do I use most often?

What belief might these errors be protecting?

What would be a more truthful way to see it?

Everyone makes these errors at times. They are habits of thinking, not flaws of character — and habits can be changed.

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind."
Romans 12:2

Thank you — this helps your counselor understand the thinking patterns that may keep painful beliefs in place. Your answers are confidential within your counseling relationship.